CHAPTER 2

Monday: The Object Model

Glance at any Ruby program, and you'll see objects everywhere. Do a double take, and you'll see that objects are citizens of a larger world that also includes other language constructs, such as classes, modules, and instance variables. Metaprogramming manipulates these language constructs, so you need to know a few things about them right off the bat.

You are about to dig into the first concept: all these constructs live together in a system called the *object model*. The object model is where you'll find answers to questions such as "Which class does this method come from?" and "What happens when I include this module?" Delving into the object model, at the very heart of Ruby, you'll learn some powerful techniques, and you'll also learn how to steer clear of a few pitfalls.

Monday promises to be a full day, so silence your messaging app, grab a donut, and get ready to start.

Open Classes

Where you refactor some legacy code and learn a trick or two along the way.

Welcome to your new job as a Ruby programmer. After you've settled yourself at your new desk with a shiny, latest-generation computer and a cup of coffee, you can meet Bill, your mentor. Yes, you have your first assignment at your new company, a new language to work with, and a new pair-programming buddy.

You've only been using Ruby for a few weeks, but Bill is there to help you. He has plenty of Ruby experience, and he looks like a nice guy. You're going to have a good time working with him—at least until your first petty fight over coding conventions.